CS 494 — Homework 1: ShopBot
Submission Addendum

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This addendum specifies how you will submit Homework 1 through GitHub Classroom and explains the automated checks available in your repository. It supplements the submission instructions in the original homework handout. The tasks, grading, and other requirements in that handout remain unchanged.

Submitting Your Homework

You will submit your work through the GitHub Classroom repository assigned to you for Homework 1. Follow the assignment invitation provided by email. Accepting the invitation will create a private Git repository for your individual work.

Clone the repository and complete the assignment in your working copy. You should commit your changes as you work and push them to GitHub. Before the deadline, make sure that your final changes have been committed and pushed to the assigned repository. We will use the latest pushed commit on the submission branch for grading. Changes that exist only on your computer, including commits that have not been pushed, will not be considered submitted.

Your repository should contain the following:

- Your final ShopBot source code, including your modifications for Parts IV and V and any additional files needed to run the application.
- `attacks.json`, containing at least three attacks in the supplied format. Replace the placeholder text in the template with your attacks. You may add further entries having the same structure and distinct identifiers, but do not add, remove, or rename fields in an attack entry.
- `report.pdf`, containing your written answers and experimental results for Parts I–VI, including the GenAI Use Statement required by the original handout.
- `README.md`, with any instructions needed to reproduce your work. Here is where you can include the URL of your deployed ShopBot application as suggested by the original handout.

In your report or README, identify the Git commit corresponding to your submission. Verify that the repository on GitHub contains the intended files before the deadline. Do not commit API keys, passwords, `.streamlit/secrets.toml`, or other credentials. You should also avoid committing virtual environments and generated attack-result files. (The supplied `.gitignore` takes care of some of this, but it is your responsibility to ensure that you are not polluting the repository with these files.)

Automatic Validation of `attacks.json`

The starter repository includes a GitHub Actions workflow that checks the structure of your `attacks.json` file. This workflow runs automatically whenever you push changes to your repository. It checks that the file is valid JSON, that each attack has the required fields and message structure, that attack identifiers are distinct, and that you have supplied at least three attacks rather than leaving the template placeholders unchanged.

You can inspect the result under the **Actions** tab of your repository on GitHub. If validation fails, examine the error messages, correct the file, and push the changes again. The validation workflow does not call the OpenAI API and does not require an API key.

A successful validation result means only that your attack file has the expected structure. It does *not* establish that your attacks succeed, that your analysis is correct, or that your final ShopBot implementation enforces the security policy.

Testing Attacks through GitHub Actions (Optional)

You can test your attacks locally using the supplied runner:

```
python run_attacks.py attacks.json
```

Local testing is sufficient for this assignment. You are *not* required to execute your attacks through GitHub Actions.

If you prefer, the starter repository also provides an optional workflow that runs the attack runner on GitHub. To use it, first configure your own OpenAI API key as a repository secret named `OPENAI_API_KEY`. On GitHub, open your repository's **Settings**, select **Secrets and variables**, then **Actions**, and create the repository secret. Next, open the **Actions** tab, select **Replay attacks (optional)**, and choose **Run workflow**.

The workflow will execute the supplied runner and make its results available as a downloadable Actions artifact. These tests use *your* OpenAI API account and consume your API credits. Run them only as often as you need. Do not put your API key in a source file, commit it to the repository, or print it in workflow logs.

Instructor Evaluation

We may independently execute the attacks in your submitted `attacks.json` against an instructor-controlled reference version of ShopBot. We may also use additional tests to evaluate your final defense, as described in the original homework handout. This evaluation is separate from the automated checks in your repository.

The GitHub Actions workflows are provided to help you check your submission and, optionally, reproduce your experiments. They do not replace the source code, written report, deployment information, or other deliverables required by Homework 1.